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01

You don't need a new phone every year

After almost decades since they officially began with the iPhone in 2007, most smartphones – whether they're Android or iPhone – have



plateaued in terms of cutting edge innovation and showcase iterative improvements year-after-year. Compare the flagship phones from the likes of Apple, Google, OnePlus, Oppo, Vivo or Samsung launched in 2022 versus 2023. Yes, newer phones will obviously be better than last year's phones, but does that justify buying them at the drop of a hat? I don't think so, if you ask me.

The modern day smartphone upgrade cycle has been pushed far too fast, often offering marginal improvements for hefty prices. Now when more smartphone brands are offering at least two years' worth of OS updates, buying new phones every year for just a bit more RAM or camera megapixels doesn't make sense – unless of course battery health keeps dropping precipitously.

02

Physical buttons aren't dead

Touchscreens are great,

but physical buttons offer tactility and accessibility unmatched in the digital realm, across various product categories. Just ask any BlackBerry user, iPhone Touch ID user or any gamer for that matter. Not everyone has the dexterity or visual ability to rely solely on touchscreens for touch-based input – think children or elders in your home.

Whether it's a satisfying click on a physical keyboard or the firm press of a volume knob, actual buttons provide a level of physical connection that touchscreens can only dream of. Therefore, physical buttons offer more subtle and precise controls, especially for tasks like gaming or other nuanced actions. Remember instinctively adjusting the volume or silencing your phone without even



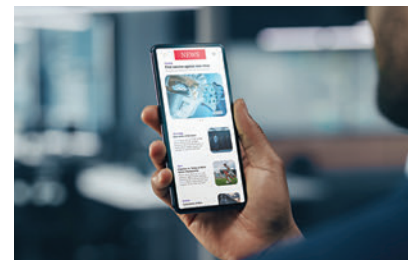
glancing at its screen? It's all thanks to physical buttons that let you interact with devices by pure feel, freeing your eyes and attention for other tasks.

03

High-resolution phone screens are overkill

Not only have smartphone screen sizes stretched over the past couple of years, so has the pixel density of the display surface packed inside

the phone's bezels. Scientific studies have shown that the human eye's natural perception of visual stimuli doesn't even reach 720p, so there's an argument there as to why even have screens that tout resolutions like 1080p, 2K, 4K UHD or beyond. But, of course, screen resolution is just part of the puzzle, as viewing distance and



screen size also matter in determining the quality of the images, either still or video, you ultimately see.

As far as phones are concerned, we know the maximum viewing distance would rarely be more than one metre. So anything about 1080p resolution on a sub-7-inch screen (which is what most smartphones have these days) is nothing but overkill for most average users. And this opinion doesn't change with foldable phones, which can potentially have even bigger screens in the future. All that pixel density is frankly wasted on smartphone screens, to be honest.

04

Social media isn't inherently bad

Before you get angry and try to tell me off in an email to editor@digit.in, at least give me a chance. I've seen the ill-effects of social media from very